

Post-incident review PIR-2025-057

Mobile Backend: elevated error rates

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 03 February 2025, Mobile Backend experienced elevated error rates in production (AU East) for about 25 minutes. A scripted sign-in probe started failing from two regions. Investigation found that a null reference in the new release crashed workers on a rare input.

Impact

Users of Mobile Backend saw elevated error rates for about 25 minutes. The service owner, Mobile Engineering, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:11 First signal received.
- 09:27 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:47 Likely cause identified.
- 10:19 Mitigation applied.
- 10:56 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that a null reference in the new release crashed workers on a rare input.

Certificates were checked as part of triage and were valid.

The expected load had not been tested before release.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Load test the service at twice the expected peak before the next campaign.
- Exercise the rollback path in staging as part of every release.
- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.